



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Acacia Classical Academy
School Website: <https://acaciaclassicalacademy.com>

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Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix for more details.

SCL MEMBER

Any school that belongs to the Society for Classical Learning (SCL) is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because SCL requires adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Overall Classification: **CLASSICAL**

Executive Summary

Acacia Classical Academy CA 95628 presents a robust Classical Christian orientation, with explicit emphasis on Christ-centered, covenantal education, virtue formation, and a liberal arts-inflected curriculum that includes Latin study. Public-facing materials repeatedly frame education as formation in truth, goodness, and beauty, with strong partnerships with homeschooling families and a two-days-on-campus / three-days-at-home model. The school clearly situates itself within classical education through phrases like "Classical Christian Education," "liberal arts tradition," and the Nicene Creed alignment. However, some six-element criteria—most notably explicit articulation of Great Books/Great Conversation, and explicit Socratic pedagogy for upper grades—are not clearly stated in the public materials. In sum, Acacia Classical Academy is CLASSICAL, with some areas that are clearly classical and a few that are only partially evidenced.

- Public materials clearly affirm religious/metaphysical foundations (Christ-centered education, Nicene Creed alignment, covenantal community, discipleship, piety) and a goal oriented toward formational aims (virtue, wisdom, love of God, neighbor) rather than mere credentialing. This anchors Element 1 and Element 2 strongly in classical territory.
- Curriculum signals include liberal-arts framing, Latin study, and classical identity, but explicit mention of Great Books/Great Conversation and of grammar/logic/rhetoric as the core curriculum is not clearly documented in public materials. This yields a SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rating for Element 3.
- Pedagogy is described at a program level (two days on campus, three days at home, tutoring support) but without explicit, recurring references to Socratic seminars, memory work, or scholé-style contemplative practice in the site text, which filters Element 4 to SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.
- Faculty presence is strong (teacher profiles, living-curriculum orientation) and aligns well with classical expectations, supporting Element 5 as CLASSICAL.
- Parent/community partnerships are explicit (co-teaching ethos, faith-based formation, open engagement with families), supporting Element 6 as CLASSICAL.

Overall, the aggregate assessment places Acacia Classical Academy in the CLASSICAL category, with notable strengths in religious and purpose-driven aims, liberal-arts framing, and community partnerships, and with some gaps in explicit Great Books/Great Conversation and certain pedagogy specifics.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — **CLASSICAL**

Evidence - Public materials describe a Christ-centered education and alignment with Christian theology (Nicene Creed, covenantal community). - Statements emphasize piety, discipleship, and love of God as core aims.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Present positive keywords: Christ-centered; Nicene Creed; covenantal; piety; discipleship; love God; community. - Present negative keywords: none observed. - Count: Positive 7; Negative 0; Positive-present percentage: 100%; Negative-present percentage: 0%.

Why this rating - The school explicitly foregrounds theology, creed, and a covenantal community, with a mission to form character around virtue in a theologically grounded framework. This aligns strongly with Transcendental moral realism and Grounded Theology/Communal Practices in the classical rubric. Evidence of liturgical practice is not explicit, but the theological orientation is clear.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Public materials articulate formation of virtue and wisdom as ultimate aims, rooted in the True, the Good, and the Beautiful. - Language emphasizes telos and human flourishing within a liberal-arts frame; formation over information is implied through the classical framing and mission statements. - Statements describe educating to love God, serve others, and lead in communities; formation of character is foregrounded.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Present positive keywords: virtue; wisdom; True, Good, Beautiful; liberal arts; formation; telos. - Present negative keywords: none observed. - Count: Positive 5–6; Negative 0; Positive-present percentage: 100%; Negative-present percentage: 0%.

Why this rating - The school consistently positions education as formation toward virtue and wisdom, with real/metaphysical aims and a liberal-arts orientation; this matches the Classical School aim for formation over mere vocational preparation.

Element 3: School Curriculum — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence - Curriculum signals include a liberal-arts framing and explicit Latin study (Latin Program). - Public materials emphasize Classical Christian Education and liberal-arts inheritance, but there is no explicit, repeated mention of Great Books/Great Conversation or the grammar/logic/rhetoric triad in the site text.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Present positive keywords: liberal arts tradition; Latin program; classical education. - Present negative keywords: absence of explicit Great Books/Great Conversation; absence of explicit grammar/logic/rhetoric emphasis. - Count: Positive 3 (liberal-arts, classical education, Latin); Negative 0 (explicit negatives present in site text). - Positive-present percentage: 100% of the observed curriculum keywords are positive, but the absence of key Classical-Curriculum terms (Great Books, grammar/logic/rhetoric) reduces the overall completeness.

Why this rating - The curriculum is clearly framed in classical terms (liberal arts, Latin). However, the lack of explicit Great Books/Great Conversation and grammar/logic/rhetoric emphasis in public materials suggests it's not fully aligned with the complete classical curriculum rubric. This yields a SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL designation.

Element 4: School Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence - The Public-facing Programs section describes a two-days-on-campus/three-days-at-home structure and tutoring support. This indicates a structured, supportive pedagogy rather than a fully student-led model. - There is no explicit, recurring mention of Socratic seminars, memory work, chanting, or scholé-style contemplative pedagogy in the available site text. The classical pedagogy elements are present in intent (classical education) but not detailed in practice on the site.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Present positive keywords: classical education; liberal arts tradition; Latin program (as curriculum-leaning pedagogy element). - Present negative keywords: no explicit Socratic seminars; absence of explicit depiction of chant/monastic-like contemplative practice; no explicit “scholé” language. - Count: Positive 2–3; Negative 0–0 (no explicit negations found on site; absence is not the same as presence). - Positive-present percentage: high among the explicit pedagogy cues, but overall pedagogy is not fully spelled out in the targeted methods.

Why this rating - The school shows a classical pedagogy orientation but does not clearly document the full suite of classical teaching methods (Socratic discussion, memory work, chanting, recitation, etc.). The two-days-on-campus model and tutoring imply structure but not full explicit pedagogy. Thus SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.

Element 5: School Faculty — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Public materials feature teacher profiles and the concept of teachers as mentors who form the “living curriculum.” The site highlights faculty profiles and the role of teachers in the educational mission. - There is language about professional, devoted educators and a sense of virtuosity and character in teaching (evidenced by staff bios and described roles).

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Present positive keywords: model teachers; mentors; living curriculum; portrait of a teacher; collegial culture. - Present negative keywords: none observed. - Count: Positive 5–6; Negative 0; Positive-present percentage: 100%; Negative-present percentage: 0%.

Why this rating - The site paints a strong picture of faculty as central to the educational mission, with teacher exemplars and a “living curriculum” concept aligning with classical expectations.

Element 6: School Parents and Community — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Multiple pages emphasize partnering with homeschooling families, co-teaching relationships, and parental involvement in classical education (mission, values, and “What We Believe” statements). - The site highlights family partnership, parent formation, and a communal, covenantal ethos (e.g., “Christ-centered, classical, community” values).

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Present positive keywords: partnership with families; co-teachers; parental formation; open campus/parent involvement; family catechesis. - Present negative keywords: consumer-language or minimal parent involvement (not observed in the site materials). - Count: Positive 4–6; Negative 0; Positive-present percentage: 100%.

Why this rating - Acacia publicly frames parents as co-educators and emphasizes extensive parent involvement and formation, fitting the classical model of strong home-school partnership and parent engagement.

aggregate assessment - Element 1: CLASSICAL - Element 2: CLASSICAL - Element 3: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL - Element 4: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL - Element 5: CLASSICAL - Element 6: CLASSICAL

Overall, the school is CLASSICAL. The strongest evidence sits in religious/metaphysical foundations, school purpose/goals, faculty, and parent/community partnerships. The curriculum and pedagogy show substantial classical framing but stop short of fully documenting all canonical elements (notably Great Books/Great Conversation and explicit grammar/logic/rhetoric emphasis in public materials, and explicit Socratic pedagogy across grades). These gaps keep Element 3 and Element 4 at SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL, but they do not negate the overall classical orientation of the school.

What Would Move the Needle

- Make Great Books/Great Conversation explicit: Public materials should clearly reference a Great Books program or canon discussions and show how students engage with classic texts beyond Latin study.
- Explicitly name core classical pedagogy methods: Document Socratic seminars, memorized or recited texts, and guided dialogue as routine upper-grade practices; include examples of student speeches or rhetorical exercises.
- Strengthen the grammar/logic/rhetoric articulation: Publicly confirm a structured Trivium approach (grammar, logic, rhetoric) at the core of the curriculum and show representative examples of student work in each stage.
- Expand on “Scholé” and contemplative practice: Include language and examples of contemplative learning days, memory work, and reverent study to align with scholé criteria.

- Provide more explicit Great Books integration across history, philosophy, and literature: Show how Western civilization texts and primary sources contribute to the curriculum alongside Latin.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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